

ACT! 6.0

Management by time

ACT! helps you plan your hours, days, months or even years. The software has an inbuilt mechanism to import or export as well as synchronise its own calendar with that of Outlook 2000 or later.

In ACT! You can make your contacts as detailed as you like, by linking notes containing any information, including the entire history of discussions between you and your contact. If supported with proper hardware, and if you have caller ID enabled on your phone, you can view detailed caller information even before you pick up the phone.

Accessing contact details is quite easy. You can search for contacts based on any field or a combination of fields. Besides all this, ACT! provides

a way to manage e-mails too.

Installing the software is a matter of just a few clicks. As soon as the software is started, a wizard helps you set up your e-mail account. There

are detailed manuals in PDF format that explain the different options available in ACT!

Although a bit unstable (it is prone to giving error messages and crashing suddenly), it emerges as a very worthy piece of time management software.

SPECIFICATIONS

Pentium 133 MHz CPU, 64 MB RAM, 50 MB free disk space, modem (optional), Microsoft TAPI-enabled telephone, hardware and Caller ID support (optional), Windows 98/2000/Me/NT 4.0/XP, Internet Explorer 5.5.

Supported Networks: Novell NetWare 5.0, Microsoft Networks, Synchronisation to Palm OS handhelds 3.0

Price: Rs 6,860
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ACT! 6.0		B
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶	
Ease of use	▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶	
Features	▶▶▶▶▶	
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶	

MSI Dragonwriter 48x16x48x

A good writer

MSI's Dragonwriter claims maximum read and write speeds of 48x on CD-Recordables and a maximum write speed of 16x on CD-Rewritables.

This CD-RW is built on the new Oak technology developed by MSI, which provides buffer underrun protection. The package includes Nero Burning ROM CD writing software, a blank CD-R and CD-RW, along with manuals for the writer and Nero. The only flaw is the absence of the IDE cable.



It offers a 2 MB buffer and features AWSS (an auto-balancing and anti-vibration System), EAC (Enhanced Adaptive Control monitor for accuracy when writing) and a Dual Radiation system for preventing overheating.

The drive has the ability to transfer data for Read/Write at 7200 KBps and for Rewrite at 2400 KBps, using the CAV (Constant Angular Velocity) writing method. It supports the R/W/RW Disk-at-once, Track-at-once, Multisession,

Packet writing and Raw writing methods. The access time required by the drive is 100 ms.

The writer supports almost all disk formats—CD-R, CD-RW, CD-ROM (mode 1 and mode 2), CD-ROM XA (mode 2, form 1 and form 2), CD-DA, Bootable CD, Photo CD (single- and multi-sessions), Video CD, CD-Extra, Mixed mode CD, and CD-text.

The drive is relatively noiseless even at high speeds and the build is sturdy.

The performance of the product is excellent. It takes 3 minutes to write assorted

Price: Rs 3,750
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Watchdog 2.0

The invisible eye

Watchdog II is a computer monitoring and spy software. It acts like a camera inside a computer, keeping track of the applications that runs on any computer on the network. You can even ban certain applications such as Solitaire and restrict access to certain sites.

It also allows you to chat with one or more people in your network. You can actually see a screenshot of any computer at any given moment and review the work being done and provide instant feedback using the chat module. You can also send an alert message to any user or shut down computers on your network remotely.

Watchdog II maintains a

data of 700 MB, and 5 to 10 seconds for an Audio CD. It wrote a rewritable CD in 5 minutes 15 seconds.

The read speeds are equally fast, and you can copy a movie/game CD in less than 3 minutes. The read speeds are equally fast, and you can copy a movie/game CD in less than 3 minutes.

SPECIFICATIONS

48x writing, 16x re-writing, 48x reading speed; 2 MB buffer; Oak buffer underrun protection technology

MSI Dragonwriter 48x16x48x		B
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶	
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶	
Features	▶▶▶▶▶	
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶	

deleted files log, giving you information of all the files deleted by the users of your network. You can also have the client e-mail you the log if you are not expected to be near the server module for a long time.

The client is a stealth application, which is not visible in the task manager, cannot be deleted once it is started, and

restarts automatically when Windows starts.

You can opt for a single license if you want to install it only on your home PC, or opt for a multiple client licenses and use the server module to monitor multiple PCs.

SPECIFICATIONS

System Requirements: Pentium-class CPU, 64 MB RAM, Windows 98, 10 MB free disk space

Watchdog II		B
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶	
Ease of use	▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶	
Features	▶▶▶▶▶	
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶	